

The Snack *Guide.*

Why snacking helps, when to snack, and what to reach for.

Benefits of *Healthy Snacking*

For years and years, snacking has come under scrutiny. Many are confused whether snacking is beneficial to overall health / weight loss or if it should be avoided. This has created a stigma on snacks.

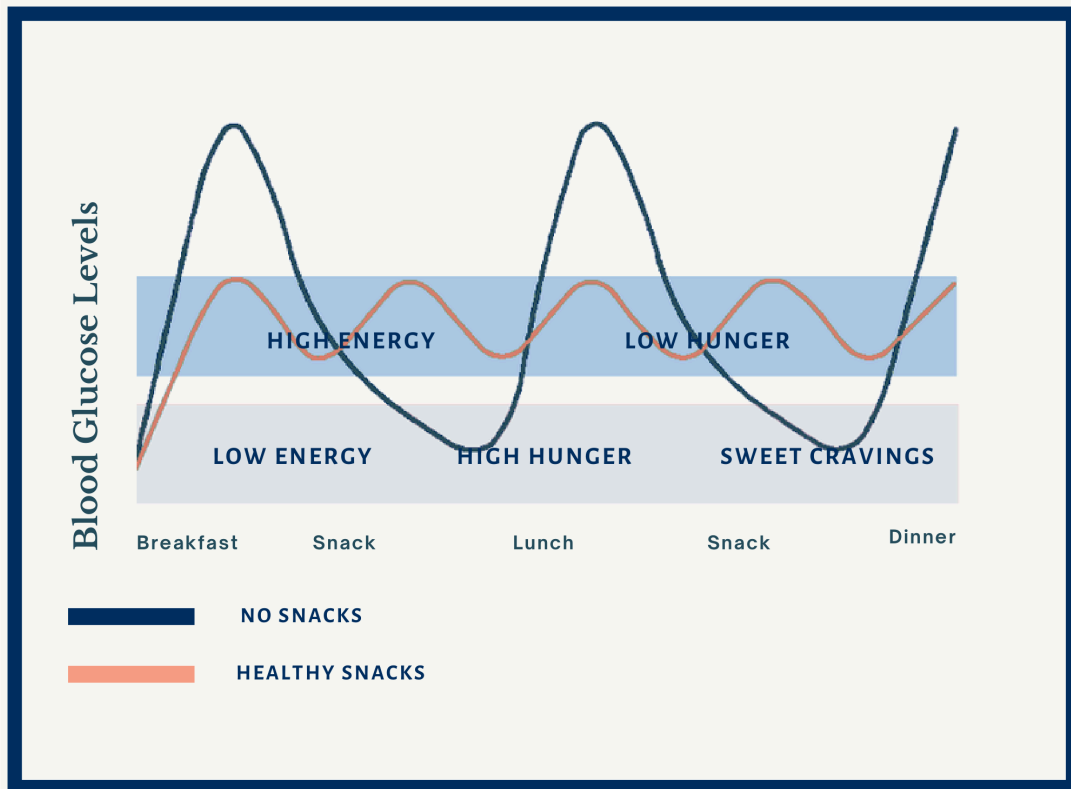
However, studies have suggested that for most, snacking throughout the day is recommended for the reasons below.

- Controls appetite throughout the day
- Prevents energy dips
- Promotes healthy weight loss
- Can help improve concentration
- Prevents overeating at meal time
- Helps stabilise energy levels between meals

Snacking and *Blood Sugar Levels*

Snacking is really important as it helps keep blood sugar levels steady during the day. If food is eaten at regular intervals throughout the day, having a dip in blood sugar levels will be less likely and therefore reaching for less nutrient-dense foods for a kick of energy will not happen.

Snacking is important to bridge the gap between breakfast and lunch and then lunch and dinner. However, snacks should not be eaten just for the sake of it, snacking is supposed to tide the body over until the next meal.



- Peaks after each meal/ snack (think balanced meals)
- Small peaks and troughs
- Blood sugar levels dip = signal to eat

How to *Snack*

- Try to eat more regularly throughout the day to prevent big gaps between meals
- Eat as much fresh fruit and vegetables as liked, but listen to the body and do not eat just for the sake of it (limit of one banana per day)
- Go for snack/cereal bars with less than 5g of sugar per 100g OR the least number of ingredients like nakd bars, which have no added sugar
- Go for savoury snacks like plain nuts and seeds, plain popcorn, lentil crisps or baked vegetable crisps with no added salt
- Be mindful of dried fruit, maximum one handful (30g) per day and nuts/nut butter, maximum one handful (30g) or portion of nuts per day
- Aim to not replace regular meals with snacks, if feeling less hungry at mealtime prepare a smaller portion of the recipe

- Add variety to snacks. For the bigger snack, alternate between protein-based snacks (boiled eggs, smoothie, Greek yoghurt) or a carbohydrate-based snack (Nak'd bars, banana bread, crackers with toppings)

Snacking System

Eating more regularly throughout the day prevents large intervals between meals, which could positively impact appetite and cravings. It is recommended to have three meals per day, breakfast, lunch and dinner, along with 2-3 healthy snacks in between. For most, eating every two-three hours works best.

Generally, that looks like this:

Breakfast
A small snack - a single portion of fruit or veg
Lunch
A bigger snack - anything bigger than a single portion of fruit or veg
Dinner
A small or bigger snack, depending on hunger levels

Some people may have these meals in a different order; perhaps having the dinner meal in the middle of the day, so may keep the bigger snack for the evening. Or if working shifts, having dinner before going to work and keeping the bigger snack for the middle of the night. The timing does not matter as long as the recommendation to eat regularly is followed, in response to actual physical hunger and not eating snacks just because “allowed”.

Small Snacks

This is the snack that most people would have to tide them over between breakfast and lunch. A small snack is a single portion of fruit or veg e.g an apple or a handful of carrot sticks.

Eat as much fruit and vegetables as you like, there is no set amount but aim for one portion each time. Listen to your body and try not to eat just for the sake of it. It is important to still intuitively consume these foods like all foods. Eat when hungry. It is not advised to over-consume any food - even healthy options.

Once something else is added to this, say a teaspoon of peanut butter or hummus, it becomes a bigger snack. So anything larger than a single portion of fruit or vegetables is a bigger snack.

Fruit and Vegetables Snack Inspiration

Strawberries	Cranberries (fresh)	Bok Choy
Cucumber	Kiwi	Watercress
Carrots	Pears	Courgette
Celery	1 banana (no more than 1 per day)	Kelp
Peppers	1 Grapefruit	Plums
Mandarins	1 large orange	Blackberries
Pears	1 cup of grapes	Asparagus
Raspberries	1 cup of pineapple	Spinach
Blueberries	1 cup of sugar snap peas	Beetroot
Broccoli	Apples	Mushrooms
Cauliflower	Peas	Pomegranate
Tomatoes	Aubergine	Melon
Radishes	Onions	

Bigger Snacks

We also recommend bigger snacks. With regards to “bigger” snacks, some women may only need one per day and others more. If you exercise intensively (running, gym workout, HIIT training etc.) regularly you may need more compared to someone that is less mobile.

It is recommended to have a bigger snack between lunch and dinner, this will prevent sugar cravings and support your appetite until dinner. You may require another snack in the evening. Some days you may need 2 bigger snacks and some days, 1. Tune in and be flexible based on how you feel.

Bigger Snack Inspiration

3 crackers with nut butter. cream cheese, cottage cheese, hummus, avocado, cheddar or tuna

1 natural cereal bar of your choice (Nakd brand is a healthy option)

Apple slices with 1 tablespoon of nut butter

Small handful of nuts and raisins

1 banana sliced and topped with 1 tablespoon of nut butter

2 medjool dates and cream cheese or nut butter

1 cup of grapes and 1 boiled egg

2 boiled eggs

30g dark chocolate

1 cups of homemade popcorn

125g of Greek yoghurt and fruit

High Protein / Low Carb *Snacks*

Smoothie

2 Eggs

Greek Yoghurt (125G) with berries

Egg muffins

Apple slices with 1 tbsp peanut butter

Small handful of nuts

Celery sticks and cream cheese

Chocolate chia-pudding

Any type of meat/fish

An important note is to have a good variety across meals and snacks, do not have a smoothie for a snack if having one for breakfast. The same goes for eggs, it is okay to have them as a snack if not having eggs at breakfast/lunch.

Final *Note*

The snacking system is a guide, some people may need to consume another bigger snack in the evening before bed if they are hungry. It is important to remember to check in for physical hunger and that physical hunger should never be ignored.

For some, having the larger snack is most beneficial between lunch and dinner in the afternoon as this period is the longest window between meals. However, it may differ depending on the individual circumstances, taking into account physical activity and hunger levels.

It is important to feel satisfied by what foods are being consumed, so remember to check in with hunger and fullness levels. Also remember, these are guidelines and often people may need a little more or less. Larger people require more food than those who are smaller.